That Damn Sword

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/34374406.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra)

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by DeltaFell

Summary

During class one day, Catra notices something strange. What is that sword? Why is it so familiar? Maybe her roommate Glimmer will know.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

The first time Catra saw the sword, it was a complete accident. She had zoned out in class again, and was doodling in her notebook idly. It was a hand-and-a-half broadsword with a golden hilt and strange linear designs running down the blade. She didn't really think much of it, just a cool design, maybe something to flesh out later and put up as a reward for her subscribers.

Catra's nosy-as-fuck roommate saw it while 'borrowing' Catra's notes, who, while she loved it, had several things to say.

"You're such a fucking stereotypical lesbian, Catra," Glimmer said. "First the 'I just feel like there's someone out there meant for me' and now you're drawing swords in class? If you show up with some girl I've never met and a u-haul truck one day I'm going to commit a fucking double homicide."

"That would be a hate crime, Sparkles," Catra said.

Glimmer flipped Catra off and returned to her room.

Catra doodled out a rough sketch of the wielder of this sword, a tall, gorgeous blonde with muscular arms and a dorky outfit. Maybe she was letting some of her personal biases bleed into the art, but fuck it, its not like anyone but Glimmer would know.

The second time Catra saw the sword was a little stranger than the first. There was this little coffee-and-bagel place by her

apartment that was great for mornings when she really didn't want to go to the trouble of actually cooking something, but still wanted a hot meal.

The cashier was fucking beautiful, and she wasn't the only reason Catra kept coming back on monday mornings. The bacon-avocado-sprouts-bagel-thingy was fucking gold, and definitely a way to brighten up her day before ENGL 102. Fuck that class, and fuck Professor Weaver.

Catra was in the middle of internally bemoaning the many faults of Professor Weaver when the cashier winced as she worked the cash register, revealing the inside of her arm to Catra. Tattooed on the inside of her right arm was the exact same sword, even down to the imperfections of the first draft. Catra's jaw hung open with shock, how the hell had this woman managed to get an exact copy of her first draft of the sword before anyone other than Glimmer had seen it.

For a moment, Catra harbored the ugly thought that Glimmer had shared it before she was ready to post it, but she reined that line of thought in before she could start spiraling. The tattoo looked pretty old, a nd she had only drawn the sketch a few days ago, definitely not enough time for the woman to get a tattoo modeled after it."

"Oh don't worry about me, I'm fine, I just pulled my shoulder playing football," the cashier said.

Catra gulped hard. Hot and strong.

“Name and your order, handsome?”

“Uh, I’m Catra and uh how about that bacon-avocado-sprouts-bagel-thingy,” Catra said.

“The Kramer? Would you like anything else with that?”

“Fuck me,” Catra muttered. “No that’ll be all.”

The cashier grinned. “Maybe later sweetheart.”

Catra choked.

When Catra got her bagel, written on the side of the bag was a phone number. She grinned slightly and added the number to a new contact.

A few months passed before Catra saw that sword where it shouldn’t be again. After texting that cashier in class - her name was Adora - and getting to know her a little bit better, they started dating, and Catra saw the sword all the time, but the sword was supposed to be there, on her arm. It definitely wasn’t supposed to be on the doors of a new gym.

Like Adora's tattoo, this sword had all the imperfections of the first draft replicated exactly.

Catra and Adora exchanged a glance and then entered the gym. It was clearly still being set up, with unpacked boxes littering the track and the area inside it. Some machines had been assembled already, but not many.

"Uh, excuse me, is there anyone here?" Catra asked into the empty building.

"Oh hello, one minute, I'll be right out!" said a voice.

Sure enough, almost exactly one minute later (58.75 seconds later, Adora started a timer), a short woman with long purple hair emerged from a door behind the front desk.

"Hi, so sorry about that, just so much to do, and my business partner isn't even here yet!" the woman said.

"I'm sorry," Catra asked, "do I know you?"

The purple haired woman pulled out a cellphone and scrolled through it briefly.

"No, I don't believe so. My name's Entrapta, how can I help you?"

“I’m Catra, do you know where the design on your door came from?”

“What design?” said Entrapta

“The big sword with all the markings on it on your front door.”

“Oh that design. Yeah I have absolutely no idea. It just showed up one day, nobody even showed up drawing it on the security footage. Very bizarre.”

“Yeah, it is,” said Adora.

Catra and Adora had just finished the first movie of date night when everything went wrong.

“Isn’t everything just perfect Adora?” Catra said.

Adora frowned. “No.”

“What, do you not like me anymore or something?” Catra laughed nervously.

“Think Catra, what were you doing before this, what’s the last thing you remember? Something’s wrong, Catra, something’s very wrong.”

Catra began to protest, but as she sat there and as she thought, Catra came to a horrifying realization.

“The last thing I remember is the gym. Oh good fuck, the last thing I remember is the gym.”

“Catra, that was almost a year ago, and that’s the last thing I remember too. What the heck is going on?” Adora said.

“I don’t know!” Catra shouted.

Around them, their house disintegrated into a skyward beam of purple. The outer walls and the roof were the first to go, as the beam chewed away at the house from the outside in.

“What the fuck is happening?” Catra asked, “What the fuck is this glowy purple shit?”

Just before the beam reached one of the hallways, a young magicat stepped into the living room. They had blonde hair and blue eyes like Adora, but they definitely had Catra’s cat eyes and tail.

“Mom, Mama, what’s happening?” they said.

Before Catra could respond, the beam ripped away at the rest of the world, and she found herself clinging for her life with one hand on the edge of some cliff. Adora stood above her, face flushed with exertion and a hand extended out.

“Grab my hand Catra, we can fix it together!” Adora said.

Catra felt herself slipping. She wasn’t going to make it. Her hand spasmed and she fell, smiling sadly at Adora as she fell down, down into the enigmatic purple beam.

End Notes

And that's the end of the backlog I wrote up in August folks. Sorry about the late posting again folks, got roped into a couple of shindigs on campus. I don't think I'll be late next week, but lmao we'll see if anything catches fire.

This was an interesting one to write. It got a lot of inspiration from where I lived over the summer, despite me moving back to where I attend college like a month prior. The Kramer was this bagel thing at like a bread shop down there. It fucking slapped and significantly improved multiple mornings where I did not have the energy to make breakfast. If any of you make something like that, this one's for you.

Happy Lesbian Day to all the lesbians reading this!

A huge fuckin thanks to Zeroan. She was a fucking massive help with all this, and is a phenomenal writer. I still maintain that y'all should check out his stuff

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!